

FOR ALBANIAN HIGH-SCHOOL STUDENTS · FREE · OPTIONAL · IN ENGLISH

Finish the month. Meet the scientist.

Albania Now connects Albanian youth directly with working scientists at institutions including NASA Goddard and UC Berkeley. Students earn that connection by completing real work — and everything described in these pages is built and live today, not a plan.

Mirë se vini · Welcome

Live now: santerre.ai/albania-now

The model: earned access to real authority

1 · A SPRINT

Four weeks of material on one topic — video lectures, audio, interactive reading, Colab notebooks, weekly builds. One lesson a week.

2 · VERIFIED COMPLETION

The platform checks the work — automatic checks plus human review of capstones. No teacher grading, no school administration.

3 · THE LECTURE

Completers join a live video lecture with the sprint's scientist and ask their questions. Recorded and published afterward.

4 · THE ARTIFACTS

A certificate with a public verification link, and a physical sticker, mailed to the school and handed out in person.

The engine is authority. The lecture matters because a scientist of real standing attends to the student's work — validation a teenager cannot buy. The certificate carries the same names. This is the value the program exists to deliver.

The honest mechanics pledge: no streaks, no guilt notifications, no ranking of students — the one deadline is the cohort's lecture date, and missed progress always carries forward.

One destination, many doors

Students differ; the doors are shaped for them. Every door leads to the same place — effort earning a scientist's attention.

DOOR	SHAPE	WHAT'S BEHIND IT (LIVE TODAY)
Sprints	class-shaped	Seven 4-week courses with videos, notebooks, and builds
Games	game-shaped	The Eagle's Flight — a 16-level game where the eagle flies the program you write, functions and all · plus three weekly share-your-grid challenges (code reading, crater detection, chart lies), same puzzle for the whole country every Monday
Events	event-shaped	The lectures, school watch parties, sticker ceremonies, and a season finale week when every sprint's lecture lands together
Community	community-shaped	A moderated Discord; crews of 3–5 who complete together

A kid who would never enroll in a course will play the eagle game. The games funnel to the sprints; the sprints end at the lecture.

Seven sprints, ready now

SPRINT		CLOSING LECTURE
01	Data Science, from zero	Dr. John Santerre — UC Berkeley
02	Planetary Exploration	Dr. Conor Nixon — NASA Goddard
03	Intro to Large Language Models	Dr. John Santerre — UC Berkeley
04	AI Image Analysis on Other Planets	Dr. Conor Nixon — NASA Goddard
05	Leveraging AI in Your Own Education	Dr. Nedelina Teneva — ML researcher
06	Learning to Read Python	To be announced
07	Learning to Learn from External Resources	To be announced

Every lesson: video + audio + interactive reading + notebook + optional go-deeper + check + build. Notebooks are unit-tested; lesson pacing is measured, not guessed. The material extends **Chicago First**, a ten-course curriculum built for Chicago high-school students, and the catalog grows every season.

Designed to spread through schools

The share loop. Every game produces a result worth posting — an emoji grid, a branded card — with the link inside. Same weekly puzzle for the whole country, so grids invite comparison.

Crews. Students join in threes to fives; the crew completes together, earns together — and a crew that needs a fourth member recruits one.

School pride. A public wall counts completers by school. Schools compete; students never do.

Seasons. All cohorts move on one calendar with a shared finale week; season-unique stickers never return; Founding Season certificates are numbered from #1.

The public record. Lecture recordings are published with highlight clips — outsiders see exactly what they missed and how to earn it.

The story. A NASA scientist lecturing Albanian teenagers who did the work is a national story in a country of 2.7 million — timed to the first finale, not the first upload.

What it runs on, and what we ask

Self-funded and cheap by design. Static pages plus free tools today; a full app — sign-in, automatic progress, verified certificates — is specified and budgeted at under \$2,000 per month even at national scale, funded by Free Focus.

Free for students, forever. No fees, no advertisements, no data for sale. Minimal data, parental consent, moderated spaces, stickers shipped to schools.

No burden on teachers. The platform verifies completion. Schools distribute, lend lab time, and host the ceremonies.

From schools: tell students it exists; a projector for watch parties; a computer-lab slot for phone-only students.

From the Ministry: endorsement, one circular to directors, a liaison — the full non-financial request is at santerre.ai/albania-now/proposal.html.

From scientists and engineers: one hour on a video call with students who earned the seat. The material machinery for a new sprint already exists.